



JUDGING CRITERIA & GUIDELINES

1. Purpose of the Judging Framework

This framework makes IMPACT X judging consistent, transparent, fair, and practical across all rooms and all six tracks. It evaluates whether a team solves a meaningful problem, creates measurable impact, builds a credible solution, has a realistic path to adoption and return on value, and can continue beyond the hackathon.

Core principle: IMPACT X rewards the strongest combination of impact, innovation, technology, feasibility, business value, and long-term potential, not the most complex technology or the most polished presentation alone.

2. IMPACT X Tracks

Track	Primary SDG	Focus
Education	SDG 4 – Quality Education	Access, learning outcomes, skills, teaching, student experience, educational productivity.
Healthcare	SDG 3 – Good Health & Well-being	Access, prevention, patient experience, delivery, efficiency, affordability, outcomes.
Smart Cities	SDG 11 – Sustainable Cities & Communities	Mobility, infrastructure, citizen services, sustainability, resource optimization, safety.
Accessibility	SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities	Removing physical, digital, social, or economic barriers and empowering underserved users.
Business & Productivity	SDG 8 – Decent Work & Economic Growth	Revenue, cost reduction, automation, workforce productivity, decisions, operations, new opportunities.
Affordable & Clean Energy	SDG 7 – Affordable & Clean Energy	Energy access, affordability, renewables, efficiency, storage, smart management, consumption reduction, environmental impact.

3. Judging Structure

Stage	Process	Outcome
Round 1 (Parallel Rooms)	Teams present in parallel rooms. Each judge independently scores every assigned team out of 110.	Teams are ranked within each room.
Qualification	Recommended: top 3 teams per room. It may have difference if there is no balance in number of teams per room.	Finalist pool.
Round 2 – Final	Finalists present to a larger cross-functional panel using the same 10-minute maximum.	Final ranking.
Awards	Ranking determines the overall winners.	Exactly 3 winners. (we can rank the top 9 teams without prizes)

4. Scoring System

Criterion	Points	What It Measures
Problem Definition & Relevance	10	Real, important, clearly defined problem and evidence.
Impact & Track/SDG Alignment	15	Depth, reach, measurability, and relevance of impact.
Innovation & Creativity	10	Originality, differentiation, and creative effectiveness.
Solution Quality & User Experience	10	Usability, accessibility, user journey, and effectiveness.
Technical Implementation	15	Functionality, architecture, technical quality, and appropriateness.
Feasibility & Execution	10	Realistic implementation, resources, constraints, and roadmap.
ROI & Business Model	15	Value proposition, revenue/savings/funding, market, customer, return/value.
Sustainability & Continuity	10	Post-hackathon survival, maintenance, scalability, and long-term support.
Presentation & Communication	5	Clarity, structure, demo, storytelling, and answers.
CORE SCORE	100	Criteria 1–9.
Google Technology Bonus	+5	Meaningful Google technology integration.
Presentation Efficiency Bonus	+5	Efficient use of the 10-minute limit.
FINAL SCORE	110	Core score plus bonuses.

5. Detailed Judging Rubric

5.1 Problem Definition & Relevance — 10 Points

- Problem is clear, specific, and significant.
- Target users/beneficiaries are understood.
- Research, interviews, data, or credible assumptions support the problem.
- Existing alternatives are understood where relevant.

Judge test: Would this problem still matter if the hackathon did not exist?

5.2 Impact & Track/SDG Alignment — 15 Points

- Potential positive impact is clear.
- Strong alignment with the selected track and SDG.
- Reach and depth of impact are credible.
- Impact KPIs are identified.
- Team explains how outcomes will be measured.

Judge test: Who benefits, how much, and how will the team prove the impact?

5.3 Innovation & Creativity — 10 Points

- Originality or creative problem-solving.
- Meaningful differentiation from alternatives.
- Novel or unusually effective approach.
- Innovation may be technological, business-model, process, experience, or service innovation.

Judge test: What is meaningfully different or better?

5.4 Solution Quality & User Experience — 10 Points

- Solution directly addresses the problem.
- User journey is intuitive.
- Design fits intended users.
- Accessibility is considered where relevant.
- Prototype demonstrates core value.

Judge test: Can a real target user understand and use it?

5.5 Technical Implementation — 15 Points

- Working functionality appropriate to hackathon scope.
- Technology choices fit the problem.
- Architecture and implementation show competence.
- Core integrations/workflows function.
- Relevant security, privacy, reliability, data, and scalability considerations are addressed.
- Complexity is rewarded only when it creates value.

Judge test: Does the technology genuinely enable the proposed value?

5.6 Feasibility & Execution — 10 Points

- Realistic technical and operational path.
- Dependencies, constraints, risks, and resources are understood.
- Credible MVP/pilot roadmap.
- Reasonable assumptions about deployment, partners, regulation, or infrastructure where relevant.

Judge test: If funded tomorrow, could this realistically move toward launch?

5.7 ROI & Business Model — 15 Points

- Clear value proposition.
- Clear customer, payer, beneficiary, or funding source.
- Credible revenue, savings, funding, adoption, or value model.
- Market opportunity and alternatives are understood.
- Reasonable cost/pricing/savings/return assumptions.
- ROI may be financial, social, environmental, or organizational depending on the track.

Judge test: Who pays or funds it, why, what does it cost, and what measurable value is created?

5.8 Sustainability & Continuity — 10 Points

- Clear post-hackathon roadmap.
- Maintenance and continued development plan.
- Scalable beyond initial pilot/prototype.
- Credible funding, revenue, partnership, or institutional support.
- Clear next milestone and evidence of commitment.

Judge test: What happens after IMPACT X ends?

5.9 Presentation & Communication — 5 Points

- Clear structure and storytelling.
- Problem, solution, demo, impact, ROI, and future are understandable.

- Complex ideas are explained simply.
- Demo is relevant and credible.
- Questions are answered effectively.

Judge test: Can the team communicate the value clearly within the allotted time?

6. Score Anchors

Level	Meaning
Outstanding	Exceptional evidence, execution, differentiation, and potential; top-end score is justified.
Strong	Clearly above average with convincing evidence and minor gaps.
Good	Solid and credible but with noticeable limitations or unanswered questions.
Weak	Significant gaps, limited validation, or weak execution.
Very Weak	Criterion is largely unaddressed, unsupported, or contradicted by the demonstration.

7. Google Technology Bonus — Up to +5

IMPACT X is powered by Google. The bonus rewards meaningful integration, not the number of Google products mentioned.

Bonus	Guideline
+5	Google technology is central and materially enables or improves the solution.
+3 to +4	Meaningful integration with clear product value.
+1 to +2	Appropriate but non-central use.
0	Superficial mention, irrelevant use, unsupported claim, or no meaningful Google contribution.

Fairness rule: Using a Google API, SDK, platform, or service does not automatically earn +5.

8. Presentation Efficiency Bonus — Up to +5

Every team has a maximum presentation time of 10 minutes. The bonus rewards efficient communication and preparation, not simply speaking quickly.

Duration	Bonus
6:00 or less	+5
6:01–8:00	+3
8:01–9:59	+1
Over 10:00	0 bonus + time violation

Timing must be standardized across all rooms. Use the same timer and rules for every team.

9. Technical + Business Judge Balance

Perspective	Particular Attention
Technical Judge	Technical implementation, architecture, functionality, integrations, feasibility, scalability, security/privacy where relevant.
Business Judge	Problem relevance, impact, ROI, business model, market/adoption, sustainability, customer value, execution.
All Judges	Every criterion is scored. Expertise informs judgment; it does not replace the unified rubric.

10. Round 1 — Parallel Judging

- Each judge independently scores every assigned team out of 110.
- Judges submit individual scores before discussing a team.
- Official room score = arithmetic average of valid judge scores.
- Teams are ranked within their room.
- Recommended: top 3 teams from each room advance.
- If room sizes differ materially, organizers will decide the number of qualified teams of the room.
- Qualification rules must not change after Round 1 begins.

11. Room-to-Room Fairness

- Same rubric, score sheet, timing, and presentation rules in every room.
- Brief all judges together before judging starts.
- Use the same score anchors and definitions.
- Where practical, balance technical and business expertise across rooms.
- Judge against the rubric, not against the previous team.
- Do not revise a score merely because a later team seems stronger.
- Borderline qualification cases may receive a structured calibration review based on original scores and the rubric.

12. Round 2 — Final

- Finalists present again with the same 10-minute maximum.
- Final panel should ideally include technology, business, impact/SDG, industry, and Google-technology expertise.
- Final judges score independently before discussion.
- Final assessment should emphasize impact, technical credibility, ROI/value, feasibility, continuity, and scalability.
- Exactly three overall winners are selected.

13. Tie-Breaking Rules

Priority	Tie-Break
1	Higher Impact & Track/SDG Alignment score.
2	Higher ROI & Business Model score.
3	Higher Technical Implementation score.
4	Higher Sustainability & Continuity score.
5	Higher Feasibility & Execution score.
6	If still tied, final panel conducts a structured comparison using the same rubric and records the decision.

14. Conflict of Interest & Fairness

- Judges must disclose relevant conflicts of interest.
- A conflicted judge should not score the affected team where practical.
- Judges must not coach, favor, penalize, or influence a team during judging.
- Claims should not receive full credit without supporting evidence or a credible plan.
- Presentation charisma must not compensate for weak impact or execution.
- Technical complexity must not automatically mean a higher score.

15. Track-Specific Impact Guidance

Track	Examples of High-Value Impact
Education	Learning outcomes, access, affordability, engagement, skills, teacher/student productivity.
Healthcare	Access, prevention, patient outcomes, quality, affordability, clinical/operational efficiency.
Smart Cities	Mobility, citizen services, infrastructure efficiency, sustainability, resource use, safety.
Accessibility	Independence, inclusion, affordability, usability, participation, removal of barriers.
Business & Productivity	Revenue, cost reduction, automation, productivity, decisions, customer value, operational efficiency.
Affordable & Clean Energy	Lower energy costs, renewable adoption, efficiency, access, storage, consumption reduction, emissions reduction, environmental/social value.

16. Recommended 10-Minute Presentation Flow

Section	Purpose
Problem	What is the problem and who experiences it?
Why It Matters	Evidence, urgency, scale, and impact.
Solution	What did the team build and how does it solve the problem?
Live Demo	Show the core workflow/value.
Technology	Explain architecture and meaningful Google technology use.
Impact + ROI	Show measurable outcomes and financial/social/environmental/organizational value.
Continuity	Explain the roadmap from prototype to MVP/pilot and beyond.

17. Official Judge Score Sheet

Criterion	Max	Score
Problem Definition & Relevance	10	___ / 10
Impact & Track/SDG Alignment	15	___ / 15
Innovation & Creativity	10	___ / 10
Solution Quality & User Experience	10	___ / 10
Technical Implementation	15	___ / 15
Feasibility & Execution	10	___ / 10
ROI & Business Model	15	___ / 15
Sustainability & Continuity	10	___ / 10
Presentation & Communication	5	___ / 5
CORE SCORE	100	___ / 100
Google Technology Bonus	+5	___ / 5
Presentation Efficiency Bonus	+5	___ / 5
FINAL SCORE	110	___ / 110

18. Judge Quick Checklist

- What real problem is being solved?
- Who benefits and what measurable impact results?
- Does the demonstrated solution work?
- Is the technology appropriate and credible?
- What makes the approach innovative or better?
- Who pays, funds, adopts, or benefits—and why?
- What is the expected ROI or measurable value?
- Can it realistically launch?
- What happens after the hackathon?
- Can it scale?
- Was Google technology used meaningfully?
- Did the team communicate effectively within 10 minutes?

19. Definition of an IMPACT X Winner

An IMPACT X winner is not simply the team with the best prototype. It is the team that most convincingly demonstrates that a real problem can be addressed through an innovative, technically credible, feasible, economically or socially valuable solution with a realistic path to sustainable impact beyond the hackathon.



Build what matters. Prove it works. Make the impact last.